

Reinventing Apple Pay for Indian Markets - GTM 2026

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Payment Ecosystem in India

What Happened -

Apple Pay expected to launch in India in 2026
~Bloomberg report

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Technology

Apple in Talks With Banks to Start Payment Service in India

By Sankalp Phartiyal and Anup Roy

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Why Now -

RBI has given legal validity to FaceID, giving advantage to Apple Pay



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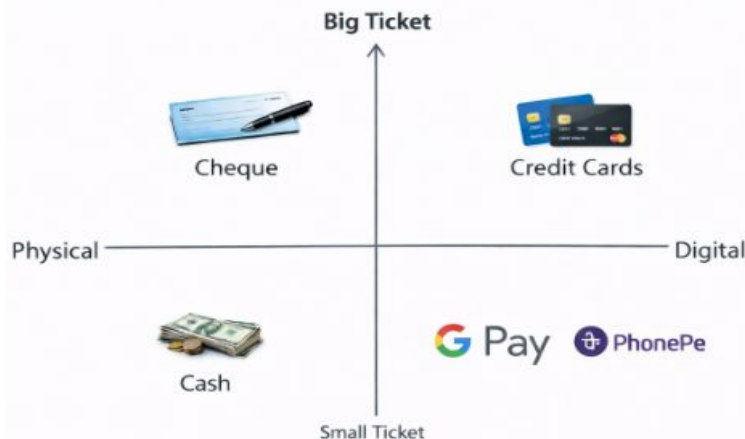
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RBI Unveils New Digital Payment Authentication Rules: 2FA Mandatory, More Options Beyond SMS OTP from April 2026

Written by: Neha Dubey • Updated on: 26 Sept 2026, 10:07 am IST • EN

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has announced that new digital payment authentication rules will come into force on April 1, 2026.

Current Indian Payment Ecosystem Visualized -



Indian Market Nos.-

15 Mil

IPhones in India

2.2 Tril

Annual Credit
card spending
(Rupees)

20.4 Bil

Annual UPI
Transactions

Apple Pay - Entering the Red Ocean -



- Strong user stickiness to GPay/PhonePe as well as Credit Cards, making it a challenging GTM
- It would be difficult to convince users to directly add credit cards to Apple Pay due to trust issues with new app.

UPI First, Cards Later

Why directly attacking cards will fail -

Payment Method	Freq of usage	Net Friction
Cards	Low	Medium
UPI	High	High

A new wallet needs high-frequency usage to build trust and mindshare !

Therefore, we should build UPI solutions, and then nudge towards credit card

Where current ecosystem lacks -



Cyber Security -

Gap: Shoulder surfing is a ground reality in crowded Indian markets

Strategy: No need for PIN.



Accessibility -

Gap: Old people find it difficult to use such apps

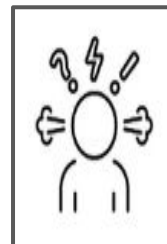
Strategy: 0 step payments



Privacy -

Gap: Lack of Non-tracking transaction apps.

Strategy: Apple's privacy-centric ecosystem.

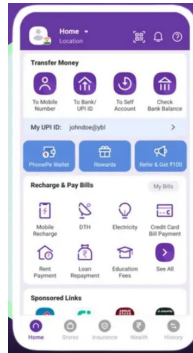


Convenience -

Gap: All apps require long user journey.

Strategy: Apple Pay's FaceID

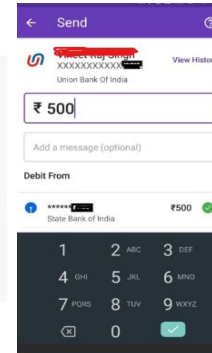
UPI User Journey - Current apps in market - high friction -



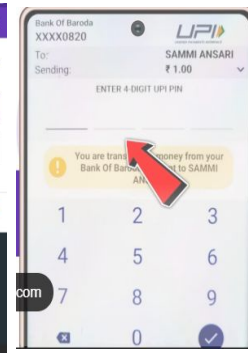
Step 1 -
Find app icon on screen



Step 2 -
Scan the QR



Step 3 -
Enter Amount



Step 4 -
Enter PIN



Step 5 -
Payment Done

Apple Pay, reinvented for UPI

New User journey - Reimagined -

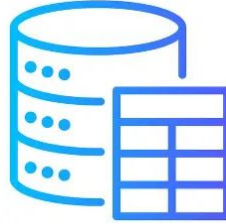
Step 1 - Point phone to QR code, while looking at the screen, and double press power button.

Step 2 - Say "Siri Pay X rupees"

Step 3 - DONE ! No need to even open the app

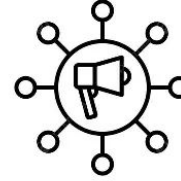


Why this is a win for Apple -



Data Denial:

Disrupting the data-monetization model of local competitors.



Organic Advocacy:

"Siri, pay" is so fast it becomes a social status signal



'No-Go-Back' Effect:

After experiencing 0 step payments, moving to a manual app flow feels like a downgrade.

Friction Step	New step	Technology used
Opening App	Just point camera	Vertical Integration
Typing PIN	Look at screen	FaceID Authorization
Typing amount	Speak the amount	Siri Integration

Why Apple is uniquely positioned to solve this-

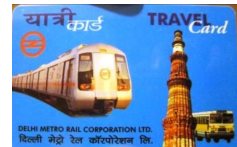


Apple's Moat = Control over hardware and software.

Apple has the ability to remove the need to open app altogether ! No competitor can achieve this !

Bonus feature- metro cards -

Apple NFC Tech can be used for this



Appendix

References -

[Apple in Talks With Banks to Start Payment Service in India - Bloomberg](#)

[RBI Unveils New Digital Payment Authentication Rules: 2FA Mandatory, More Options Beyond SMS OTP from April 2026](#)

[IDC reports India smartphone market flat at 152 million units in 2025](#)

[Credit Card Spending in India Soars to New Heights: September 2025 Sees Record Transactions, ETBFSI](#)